

Parliament: Composition, Sessions, Officers and Legislative Procedure

UPSC Polity Learning Session Handout

Subject: GS Paper II / Prelims GS Paper I - Indian Polity and Governance

Core focus: Parliament as Union legislature; bicameralism; sessions; officers; ordinary and Money Bill procedures; parliamentary control and privileges.

Official UPSC anchor: GS Paper II covers Parliament under 'Parliament, State Legislatures, Executive, Judiciary...' and Prelims GS Paper I covers it under 'Indian Polity and Governance - Constitution, Political System...'.

Memory Hook	Meaning
C-S-O-B-C	Composition, Sessions, Officers, Bills, Control
P-R-L	President + Rajya Sabha + Lok Sabha
A-P-D	Adjournment pauses a sitting; Prorogation ends a session; Dissolution ends Lok Sabha
L-25, R-30	Minimum age: Lok Sabha 25, Rajya Sabha 30
L-S-14	Money Bill: Lok Sabha only, Speaker certifies, Rajya Sabha has 14 days

Topic Roadmap

Eight subtopics covered in sequence from foundation to revision.

No.	Subtopic	Stage	Estimated Time
1	Meaning and constitutional position of Parliament	Foundation	12 min
2	Composition: President, Lok Sabha, Rajya Sabha	Core	18 min
3	Membership, tenure, qualifications and disqualifications	Core	20 min
4	Sessions: summoning, prorogation, adjournment, dissolution	Core	18 min
5	Officers: Speaker, Deputy Speaker, Chairman, Deputy Chairman	Core	20 min
6	Legislative procedure: ordinary bills	Core	22 min
7	Money Bill, Financial Bill and Budget procedure	Advanced	25 min
8	Parliamentary control, privileges and exam revision	Revision / CA-linked	20 min

Total estimated time: Concept learning 155 min; reflection and quiz 35 min; revision 30 min; MCQ practice 30 min; overall total around 250 min.

Core Learning Notes

Concise exam-ready summary of each subtopic.

1. Meaning and Constitutional Position

- Parliament is the Union legislature of India.
- Constitutionally, Parliament consists of the President, Rajya Sabha and Lok Sabha.
- The President is a part of Parliament but not a member of either House.
- Key functions: law-making, executive control and financial control.

2. Composition of Parliament

- President: formal constitutional component; gives assent, summons and prorogues Parliament.
- Rajya Sabha: Council of States; Upper House; permanent House; one-third members retire every two years.
- Lok Sabha: House of the People; directly elected; normal term of five years; can be dissolved earlier.
- Bicameral logic: Lok Sabha represents the democratic principle; Rajya Sabha represents the federal principle.

3. Membership, Tenure, Qualifications and Disqualifications

- Lok Sabha MPs are directly elected by the people from territorial constituencies.
- Rajya Sabha MPs are generally indirectly elected by elected MLAs of States and eligible Union Territory legislatures.
- Minimum age: Lok Sabha - 25 years; Rajya Sabha - 30 years.
- Disqualification grounds include office of profit, unsound mind declared by court, undischarged insolvency, citizenship issues, legal disqualification and anti-defection.

4. Sessions of Parliament

- Summoning means calling a House to meet; it is done by the President.
- Adjournment pauses or ends a sitting; it is done by the presiding officer.

- Prorogation ends a session; it is done by the President.
- Dissolution ends the Lok Sabha itself; Rajya Sabha is not dissolved.
- There cannot be a gap of more than six months between two sessions of Parliament.

5. Officers of Parliament

- Lok Sabha: Speaker and Deputy Speaker; both are elected by Lok Sabha members.
- Rajya Sabha: Chairman and Deputy Chairman. The Vice-President of India is the ex-officio Chairman of Rajya Sabha.
- Speaker presides over Lok Sabha, maintains order, decides points of order, certifies Money Bills and presides over joint sittings.
- Neutrality of the Speaker is essential for fair debate, opposition rights and executive accountability.

6. Ordinary Bills

- An ordinary bill can be introduced in either House of Parliament.
- It passes through first reading, second reading and third reading.
- The second reading is the key scrutiny stage: general discussion, committee reference if any, clause-by-clause consideration and amendments.
- A joint sitting may be used for specified deadlocks in ordinary bills, but not for Money Bills or Constitutional Amendment Bills.
- After passage by both Houses, the bill goes to the President for assent.

7. Money Bill, Financial Bill and Budget

- A Money Bill deals only with Article 110 matters such as taxation, borrowing, Consolidated Fund of India and appropriation.
- It can be introduced only in Lok Sabha and requires the President's prior recommendation.
- The Speaker of Lok Sabha certifies whether a bill is a Money Bill.
- Rajya Sabha cannot reject or amend a Money Bill; it can only recommend changes and must return it within 14 days.
- Budget is constitutionally the Annual Financial Statement. Key elements: Demands for Grants, Appropriation Bill and Finance Bill.

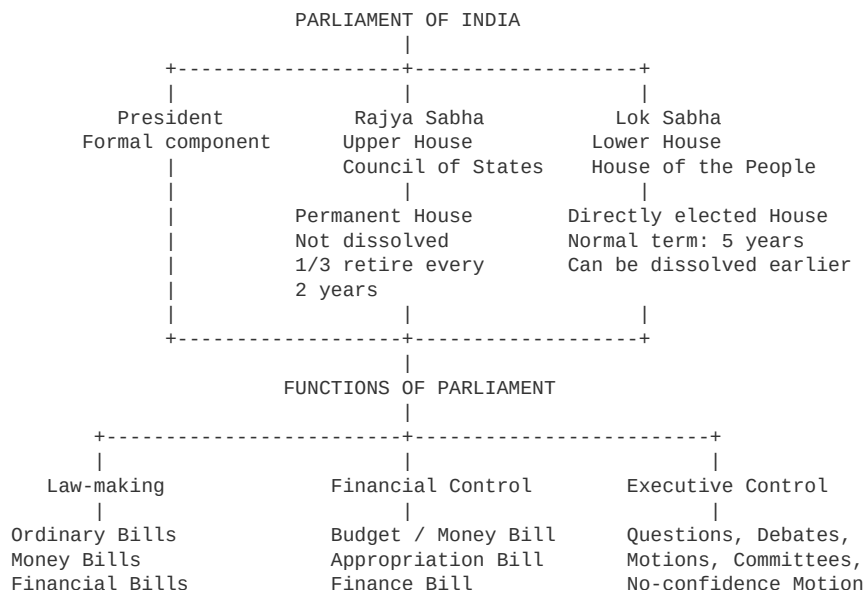
8. Parliamentary Control and Privileges

- Parliament controls the executive through questions, debates, motions, financial control and committee scrutiny.
- The Council of Ministers is collectively responsible to Lok Sabha.
- If a no-confidence motion is passed in Lok Sabha, the Council of Ministers must resign.
- Parliamentary privileges are functional safeguards, not personal exemptions.
- Privileges protect free speech in Parliament, votes given and internal proceedings, while preserving rule of law.

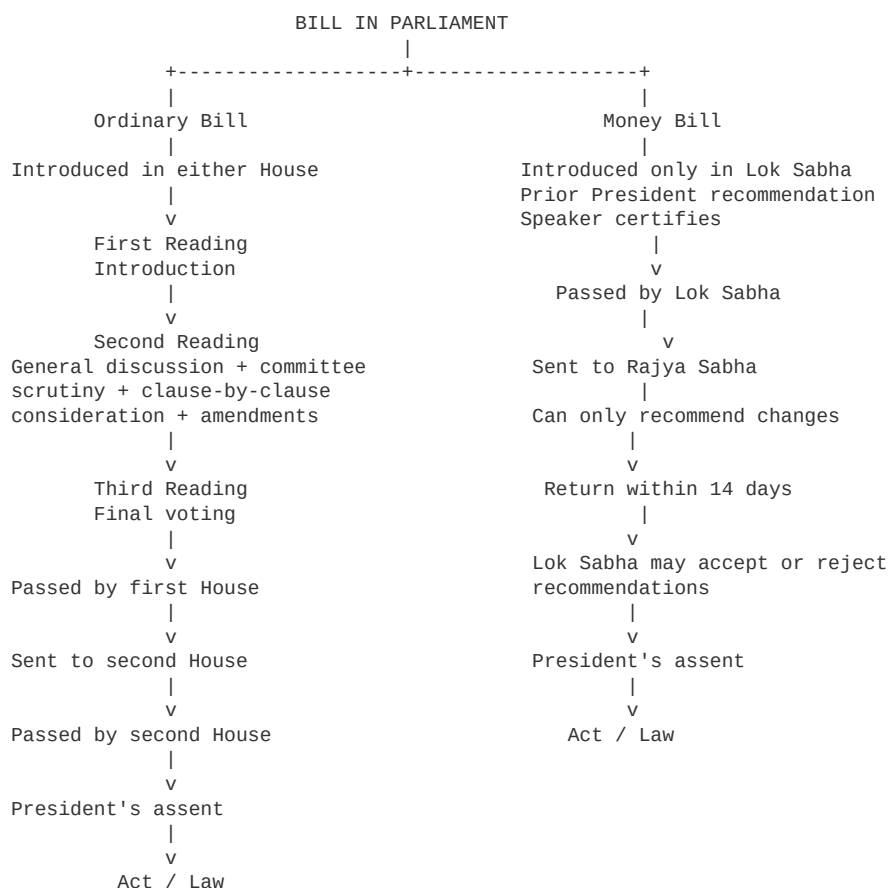
Flow Diagrams

Visual maps for fast revision.

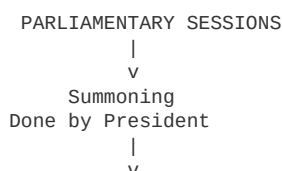
A. Composition and Functions

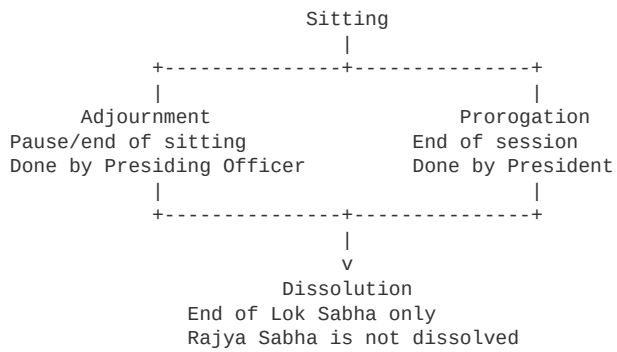


B. Ordinary Bill vs Money Bill

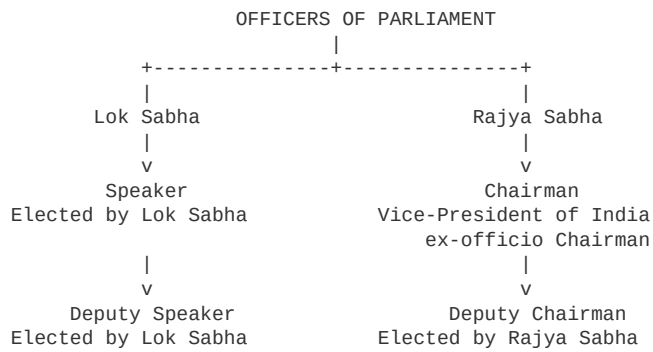


C. Sessions Flow





D. Officers Flow



High-Yield Tables

Prelims facts and Mains framing in one place.

Lok Sabha vs Rajya Sabha

Feature	Lok Sabha	Rajya Sabha
Meaning	House of the People	Council of States
Representation	People directly	States and Union Territories
Election	Direct election	Indirect election
Nature	Not permanent	Permanent House
Term	Normally 5 years; can dissolve earlier	Not dissolved
Retirement	Members go out after dissolution / election cycle	One-third retire every 2 years
Minimum age	25 years	30 years

Session Terms

Term	Meaning	Authority	Applies To
Summoning	Calling the House to meet	President	Both Houses
Adjournment	Pausing or ending a sitting	Presiding Officer	Both Houses
Prorogation	Ending a session	President	Both Houses
Dissolution	Ending the House itself	President	Lok Sabha only

Bills and Budget Terms

Term	Core Meaning	Exam Point
Ordinary Bill	General law-making bill	Can be introduced in either House
Money Bill	Only Article 110 matters	Lok Sabha only; Speaker certifies; Rajya Sabha has 14 days
Financial Bill	Contains financial provisions	All Money Bills are financial, but not all Financial Bills are Money Bills
Annual Financial Statement	Constitutional name of the Budget	Shows estimated receipts and expenditure
Demands for Grants	Ministry-wise expenditure demand	Voted only in Lok Sabha
Appropriation Bill	Authorises withdrawal from Consolidated Fund	Needed before expenditure
Finance Bill	Gives effect to taxation proposals	Linked to Budget taxation measures

Model Answers from the Session

Clean versions of key learner responses.

Why is the President part of Parliament?

It is constitutionally correct to say that the President is a part of Parliament because the Constitution defines Parliament as consisting of the President, Rajya Sabha and Lok Sabha. Although the President does not sit in either House, the President performs an essential legislative role because a bill passed by the Houses generally becomes law only after receiving the President's assent.

Why does India have two Houses of Parliament?

India has two Houses of Parliament because it follows a bicameral parliamentary system. The Lok Sabha represents the people directly, while the Rajya Sabha represents the states and Union Territories. This arrangement helps India balance democratic representation with federal representation.

Why is the Speaker's neutrality important?

The neutrality of the Speaker is important because the Speaker controls the conduct of proceedings, maintains order, decides procedural issues and protects the rights of both the ruling party and the opposition. Since Lok Sabha is the directly elected House and the main forum for executive accountability, an impartial Speaker is necessary for fair debate, scrutiny of government and dignity of the House.

Why is second reading important?

The second reading is the most important stage in the passage of an ordinary bill because it involves detailed scrutiny. The general principles are debated, the bill may be referred to a committee, clauses are examined one by one and amendments may be considered. It is the main stage for legislative deliberation and improvement.

Why does Lok Sabha dominate Money Bills?

The Lok Sabha has greater power in Money Bills because Money Bills deal with taxation, borrowing, appropriation and expenditure from public funds. Since these matters directly affect the people, the Constitution gives primacy to the directly elected House. Rajya Sabha can only make recommendations, which Lok Sabha may accept or reject.

Why are parliamentary privileges necessary?

Parliamentary privileges are necessary because they protect the independence, dignity and free functioning of Parliament. They allow MPs to raise public issues, criticise policies, vote and deliberate without fear of external pressure or legal action for protected parliamentary speech and votes. They are functional safeguards, not personal exemptions.

Final One-Line Master Summary

Parliament is the Union legislature consisting of the President, Rajya Sabha and Lok Sabha, responsible for law-making, financial control, executive accountability and democratic deliberation.